MARKETING MANAGEMENT

(IM345AT) — Complete SEE Exam Notes

Semester IV | Compiled from class notes + syllabus, unit-wise (Units I–V)

How the SEE exam is structured (from the rubric)

Total: 100 marks, 3 hours.

Part	Content	Marks
Part A	Objective-type questions covering the ENTIRE syllabus (all 5 units)	20
Part B, Q2	Unit 1 — Compulsory	16
Part B, Q3/Q4	Unit 2 — Internal choice (answer ONE)	16
Part B, Q5/Q6	Unit 3 — Internal choice (answer ONE)	16
Part B, Q7/Q8	Unit 4 — Internal choice (answer ONE)	16
Part B, Q9/Q10	Unit 5 — Internal choice (answer ONE)	16

Note: Unit 1 is compulsory in Part B — make sure it is your strongest unit. Units 2–5 each give you a choice between two questions, so you can afford to go deep on one sub-topic per unit rather than memorizing everything equally.

Note: Part A (20 marks) is objective and spans all units — so even units you don't pick for Part B still need to be revised at definition/keyword level.

UNIT I — Introduction to Digital Marketing & Content Marketing

1.1 Principles of Digital Marketing

Digital marketing is the promotion of products/services using digital channels (search, social, email, websites, mobile) to reach and engage customers, as opposed to traditional marketing (print, TV, radio, billboards).

Digital vs Traditional Marketing — key debate

- Digital marketing has largely overtaken traditional marketing in ad spend over the last decade, driven by the rise of online/social networking.
- It offers a global reach, is measurable in real time, and is generally more cost-effective than traditional advertising.
- Traditional marketing (TV, radio, print, billboards, business cards) still has value for local/offline reach and trust-building, but has limited targeting and reachability compared to digital.
- Essentially, digital marketing is where advertising and marketing meet web innovation and the different types of online media platforms.

Characteristics of Digital Marketing

- Measurable — every click, view, and conversion can be tracked.
- Targeted — audiences can be segmented by demographics, behaviour, interests, location.
- Interactive — two-way communication between brand and customer (comments, chat, reviews).
- Cost-effective and scalable — campaigns can start small and scale based on ROI.
- Real-time — campaigns can be optimized on the fly using live data.

Digital Marketing Channels

Channel	What it involves
Search Engine Marketing (SEM/SEO)	Organic (SEO) and paid (PPC) visibility on search engines like Google
Content Marketing	Blogs, videos, infographics, ebooks that attract and retain an audience
Social Media Marketing (SMM)	Organic posting + paid ads on Instagram, Facebook, LinkedIn, YouTube, X, etc.
Email Marketing	Direct, permission-based messaging to a subscriber list
Affiliate Marketing	Paying third parties/publishers a commission for driving sales/leads
Mobile Marketing	SMS, push notifications, in-app ads, mobile-optimized campaigns
Display/Programmatic Advertising	Banner ads placed automatically via ad exchanges
Influencer Marketing	Partnering with individuals who have an engaged following

Tools to Create a Buyer Persona

A buyer persona is a semi-fictional profile of an ideal customer based on research and data (demographics, goals, pain points, behaviour). Common tools:

- HubSpot Make My Persona
- Google Analytics (Audience reports)
- Facebook Audience Insights
- SurveyMonkey / Google Forms (for direct customer surveys/interviews)
- Xtensio Persona builder

Competitor Research & Website Analysis Tools

- SEMrush, Ahrefs, SimilarWeb, SpyFu — competitor keyword, traffic and backlink analysis
- Google Trends — compare search interest over time

- Google PageSpeed Insights, GTmetrix — website performance/speed analysis
- Screaming Frog — technical/on-site SEO audit

1.2 Content Marketing — Concepts & Strategies

Content marketing is a strategic approach focused on creating and distributing valuable, relevant, consistent content to attract and retain a clearly defined audience — and, ultimately, to drive profitable customer action, instead of interrupting them with traditional ads.

The 8-step Content Marketing Framework

1. **Goal Setting** — what you want to achieve with content marketing. E.g. Brand-building objectives, Sales/growth objectives.
2. **Audience Mapping** — who are your customers, and what are their aspirations and desires / pain points? Involves customer profiling & persona creation, understanding aspirations & desires.
3. **Content Ideation & Planning** — what is the overall content theme, and what is the content roadmap? Covers content theme, content formats & mix, content storyline & calendar.
4. **Content Creation** — who creates the content and when? In-house resources or agencies; needs a content production schedule.
5. **Content Distribution** — where do you want to distribute the content assets? Owned channels, Paid channels, Earned channels (word of mouth).
6. **Content Amplification** — how do you plan to leverage content assets and interact with customers? Creating conversations around content; use of buzzers and influencers.
7. **Content Marketing Evaluation** — how successful is your content marketing campaign? Tracked via content marketing metrics — impressions, unique viewers, brand recall, bounce rate, time on site.
8. **Content Marketing Improvement** — how do you improve existing content marketing? Through content theme change, format/creative improvement, and distribution & amplification improvement.

The VRSSS / Awareness-to-Advocacy funnel (from notes)

Stage	Customer state	Typical metric
Visible	Aware	Impressions
Relatable	Appeal	Unique viewers
Searchable	Ask	Brand recall
Actionable	Act	Bounce rate
Shareable	Advocate	Time on site

Reflective questions when building a content strategy

- What is the content that you think will be valuable to your customers?
- How can the content tell a story about your brand?
- How do you plan to launch your content marketing strategy?

The '7 C' quality checklist for content (from notes)

- Credible — will people believe it?
- Shareable — will the audience want to share it?
- Useful / fun — gives practical value or entertainment
- Interesting — it's subjective, but should engage
- Relevant — connects to the audience's needs
- Different — stands out from competitor content
- On-brand — consistent with brand voice and values

Planning, Creating, Distributing & Promoting Content

- Planning: content calendar, themes, formats (blog, video, infographic, podcast) mapped to buyer-journey stage (awareness/consideration/decision).

- Creating: in-house team or agency; maintain a consistent editorial/brand voice; repurpose one piece of 'pillar' content into multiple formats.
- Distributing: owned media (website/blog), earned media (PR, shares, word of mouth), paid media (boosted posts, native ads).
- Promoting: social sharing, email newsletters, influencer amplification, SEO.

Optimizing Website UX & Landing Pages (for content)

- Clear, single call-to-action (CTA) per landing page
- Fast load time and mobile responsiveness
- Scannable layout — headings, bullet points, short paragraphs
- Trust signals — testimonials, reviews, security badges
- A/B testing of headlines, CTAs, and layouts

Measuring Impact — Content Marketing Metrics & Performance

Metric type	Examples
Consumption metrics	Page views, unique visitors, time on page, downloads
Sharing metrics	Social shares, likes, comments, mentions
Lead-generation metrics	Form fills, email sign-ups, gated-content downloads
Sales metrics	Conversion rate, revenue attributed to content, ROI
Retention metrics	Return visits, subscriber churn, repeat purchase rate

Using Content Research for Opportunities

- Keyword/topic research (Google Keyword Planner, AnswerThePublic) to find content gaps
- Competitor content audits to identify under-served topics
- Social listening to find trending questions/pain points
- Analytics review of top-performing existing content to double down on what works

Unit I — Likely SEE Questions (Part B, Q2 is compulsory)

9. Explain the principles of digital marketing and how it differs from traditional marketing.
10. Describe the various digital marketing channels available to a business, with examples.
11. What tools would you use to build a buyer persona and conduct competitor research? Explain each briefly.
12. Explain content marketing and describe the 8-step content marketing framework in detail.
13. What makes content 'good' according to the 7-C quality checklist? Illustrate with an example.
14. Discuss how content is planned, created, distributed and promoted, and how its impact is measured.
15. How can content research be used to identify new content opportunities?

UNIT II — Social Media Marketing & Search Engine Optimization

2.1 Social Media Marketing — Introduction

Social Media Marketing (SMM) is the use of social media platforms to build brand awareness, engage audiences, generate leads, and drive sales through both organic content and paid campaigns.

Major Social Media Platforms for Marketing

Platform	Best used for
Facebook	Broad demographic reach, community building, detailed ad targeting
Instagram	Visual storytelling, influencer marketing, younger audience, Reels/Stories
LinkedIn	B2B marketing, professional networking, thought leadership, recruitment
YouTube	Long-form video, tutorials, product demos, retention & perceived expertise
X (Twitter)	Real-time updates, customer service, trending conversations
TikTok	Short-form video driven by emotion and novelty; trend-led discovery
Pinterest	Visual discovery, DIY/lifestyle/e-commerce inspiration

Note: Each platform serves a different psychological function in the decision journey — they aren't sequential steps but simultaneous 'micro-decision' touchpoints (search, click, tweet, buy, try, think, believe, follow, cite, imitate).

Developing Data-driven Audience & Campaign Insights

- Use platform-native analytics (Facebook Insights, Instagram Insights, YouTube Analytics) to understand audience demographics, active times, and content performance.
- Segment audiences by behaviour, interests, and engagement level for more precise targeting.
- Run A/B tests on creatives, captions, and posting times to refine strategy.
- Track campaign KPIs: reach, impressions, engagement rate, click-through rate (CTR), conversion rate, cost-per-click (CPC), cost-per-acquisition (CPA).

Social Media for Business

- Brand awareness and reputation management
- Customer service and community engagement
- Lead generation and direct sales (social commerce)
- Market research via social listening

Creation & Optimization of Social Media Campaigns

16. **Define objective** — awareness, engagement, traffic, leads, or conversions (map to platform ad objective).
17. **Define audience** — demographics, interests, custom/lookalike audiences.
18. **Choose format** — image, video, carousel, story, reel.
19. **Set budget & bidding** — CPC, CPM, or conversion-based bidding.
20. **Launch, monitor, and optimize** — pause underperforming ads, scale winners, refresh creative to avoid ad fatigue.

2.2 Search Engine Optimization (SEO) Fundamentals

SEO is the practice of improving a website's visibility in organic (unpaid) search engine results by optimizing content, structure, and authority signals.

How Search Engines Work

- Crawling — bots (e.g., Googlebot) discover pages by following links
- Indexing — content is analyzed and stored in the search engine's database
- Ranking — an algorithm orders indexed pages by relevance and quality for a given query

Keywords and SEO Content Plan

- Keyword research: identify what terms your audience searches for (Google Keyword Planner, SEMrush, Ubersuggest)
- Search intent: informational, navigational, transactional, commercial-investigation — content must match intent
- Long-tail keywords: longer, more specific phrases with lower volume but higher conversion intent
- SEO content plan: map keywords/topics to a content calendar and site structure (pillar pages + cluster/supporting content)

SEO & Business Objectives

SEO should be tied to business goals (traffic, leads, sales) — not just rankings. Writing SEO content means balancing what users want to read with what search engines need to understand and rank the page.

On-site (On-page) vs Off-site (Off-page) SEO

On-page SEO	Off-page SEO
Title tags, meta descriptions, header tags (H1/H2)	Backlinks from other reputable sites
Keyword placement in content, URL structure	Social media shares/signals
Internal linking, image alt text	Guest blogging, PR, influencer mentions
Page speed, mobile-friendliness, schema markup	Online reviews and local citations

Optimizing Organic Search Ranking

- Publish high-quality, original, in-depth content that satisfies search intent
- Improve technical SEO — site speed, mobile responsiveness, crawlability, HTTPS
- Build authoritative backlinks
- Regularly update and refresh existing content
- Use structured data/schema to earn rich snippets

Search Everywhere Optimization (from class notes) — an important evolving concept

- Search Everywhere Optimization = showing up everywhere your customers are making decisions — it's not about volume, it's about strategic presence.
- 73% of searches now happen outside Google (i.e., inside apps like Amazon, YouTube, TikTok, Instagram, Reddit, ChatGPT).
- Every platform has its own 'playbook': TikTok drives on emotion & novelty; YouTube rewards retention & perceived expertise; ChatGPT values citations & semantic clarity; Amazon rewards social proof & reviews; Instagram taps aspirational identity; Reddit rewards raw authenticity.
- Strategy must be platform-specific, not just platform-specific posting (i.e., adapt the strategy itself, not just repost the same content everywhere).
- Visibility alone isn't enough — you also need validation. Visibility = showing up in search engines/results; Validation = getting mentioned/recommended by others (what others say about you).
- The 'Google Trap': many marketers still chase page-1 rank even while search behaviour has fundamentally shifted — you can win on Google and still lose customers if you're invisible elsewhere.
- 13.7 billion searches happen daily; roughly 27% of all searches happen outside the conventional internet-wide 'one place' (traditional web search) — meaning customers are deciding across many platforms simultaneously.
- The modern customer journey is not a linear funnel — it is a constellation of 'micro-decisions' (click, tweet, buy, try, think, believe, follow, cite, imitate) happening simultaneously across platforms.

The RICE Framework (prioritizing where to invest effort)

Factor	Meaning
Reach	How many people will this action/platform reach?
Impact	How much will it move the needle on your goal?
Confidence	How sure are you this will work?

Factor	Meaning
Ease	How much effort/resources does it take?

Goal: make SEO/search-everywhere work FOR you instead of you constantly working for SEO — i.e., build durable visibility and validation rather than chasing algorithm changes.

Unit II — Likely SEE Questions (choose one of Q3/Q4)

21. Describe the major social media platforms used for marketing and the type of content/audience best suited to each.
22. Explain how data-driven audience and campaign insights are developed for social media marketing.
23. Explain the steps involved in creating and optimizing a social media campaign.
24. What are the fundamentals of SEO? Explain how search engines crawl, index, and rank pages.
25. Differentiate between on-site (on-page) and off-site (off-page) SEO with examples.
26. Explain the concept of 'Search Everywhere Optimization' and why visibility alone is not enough (visibility vs validation).
27. Explain the RICE framework and its role in prioritizing SEO/marketing efforts.

UNIT III — Web Analytics & Google Analytics; Email Marketing

3.1 Web Analytics & Google Analytics Tools

The 'Human Factor' in Analytics (from class notes)

Analytics isn't just about the tool — it depends on the people involved at every step:

- Someone at Google designs the analytics product.
- Someone installs Google Analytics on the website.
- Someone sets up preferences & reports in Google Analytics.
- Someone uses those reports to make decisions.

This means: the product may be good but the setup may be wrong; the setup may be right but the interpretation may be wrong; and both setup & interpretation may be right, but the program/decision built on them may still be wrong. Good analytics requires getting every link in this chain right.

Types of Analytics

- Web Analytics — measures website performance
- Social Analytics — measures social media effectiveness
- SEO Analytics — measures organic search performance
- User Experience Analytics — heatmaps, session recordings, journey mapping

Standard data you should get from Web Analytics

- Page views, visits, unique visitors, bounce rate, session duration
- New vs returning visitors
- Language and location of visitors
- Demographics (age, gender, interests)
- Device type, make & model; browser, OS
- Traffic source — which pages/channels people arrived from
- Keyword analysis — keywords used to reach your site
- Goal conversions — % of times a defined business goal is met
- E-commerce tracking — user behaviour on your online shop
- Funnel conversion — % of shoppers who make it from start to end of the purchase journey

Key Web Analytics Terms

Term	Meaning
Impressions	Number of times content is displayed, regardless of clicks
Unique visitors	Total count of distinct individuals visiting the site
Visits/Sessions	Total number of times a site is visited
Bounce rate	% of visitors who leave after viewing only one page
Click-through rate (CTR)	% of people who see content and click through to the destination
Conversion rate	% of visitors who complete a desired action (purchase, sign-up)

Major Web/Social Analytics Tools

- Google Analytics, Adobe Analytics — web analytics platforms
- Webtrends, Foresee — additional web analytics vendors
- Kissmetrics — customer/behaviour analytics
- Facebook Insights, Hootsuite, Brandwatch — social analytics/listening tools

Social Analytics — Key Metrics

Metric	Meaning
Reach	Total users mentioning your brand plus their followers
Engagement	People taking action on your content (likes, comments, shares)
Avg. engagement rate	Avg. rate of people who take action vs. people who saw the content
Visits	Total number of times people have been to your site/page
Unique visitors	Total number of distinct individuals
Bounce rate	People arriving and then leaving without visiting another page
Click-through rate	% of people who see your content and click through to the end location
Conversion rate	% of people who buy vs. who arrived at your site
Response rate	% of people who responded to your content
Mentions	Number of times the brand has been mentioned
Followers	Combination of all facts about your popularity
Buzz (BuZZ)	Number of conversations about you vs. competition
Share of voice	Your brand's share of total conversation, positive or negative
Sentiment	Whether mentions/conversations are positive or negative

Major social analytics tool players: Facebook Insights, Brand watch, Radian6, Hootsuite.

3.2 Email Marketing

Email marketing is a direct-marketing channel that uses email to promote products/services, nurture leads, and build customer relationships — typically the highest-ROI digital channel due to its low cost and direct, permission-based reach.

Elements of an Effective Email Campaign

- Clear, permission-based subscriber list (opt-in, avoid spam)
- Compelling subject line to maximize open rate
- Personalization — name, past behaviour, segment-based content
- Single, clear call-to-action (CTA)
- Mobile-responsive design
- Clear sender identity and easy unsubscribe option (compliance)

Building an Email Plan

28. **Define goal —** welcome/onboarding, nurture, promotional, transactional, re-engagement.
29. **Segment the list —** by demographics, purchase history, engagement level.
30. **Map the cadence/calendar —** frequency and timing of sends.
31. **Design & automate —** templates, drip/automation sequences (welcome series, cart abandonment, etc.).
32. **Test —** A/B test subject lines, send times, and content.
33. **Send, monitor & optimize.**

Email Marketing Campaign Analysis — Key Metrics

Metric	Meaning
Open rate	% of recipients who opened the email
Click-through rate (CTR)	% of recipients who clicked a link inside the email
Conversion rate	% of recipients who completed the desired action after clicking
Bounce rate (hard/soft)	% of emails that could not be delivered

Metric	Meaning
Unsubscribe rate	% of recipients who opted out after the email
List growth rate	Rate at which the subscriber list is growing
ROI	Revenue generated relative to campaign cost

Measuring Conversions & Keeping Up

- Use UTM parameters to track email traffic in Google Analytics
- Set up conversion goals for email-driven traffic
- Regularly clean the list (remove inactive/invalid addresses) to protect sender reputation & deliverability
- Stay current with data-privacy regulations (e.g., consent requirements, CAN-SPAM/GDPR-type rules) and evolving inbox/spam-filter algorithms

Unit III — Likely SEE Questions (choose one of Q5/Q6)

34. Explain the 'human factor' involved in web analytics and why the same tool can give good or bad results depending on people.
35. What standard data should you collect from web analytics? Explain with examples.
36. Explain key web and social analytics metrics such as bounce rate, CTR, reach, engagement rate, and share of voice.
37. List and explain the major web analytics and social analytics tools used in the industry.
38. What are the key elements of an effective email marketing campaign?
39. Explain how you would build an end-to-end email marketing plan.
40. How is an email marketing campaign analyzed? Explain key metrics used to measure conversions.

UNIT IV — Web Design & Mobile Marketing

4.1 Web Design & Optimization of Websites

Good web design is not about being an award-winning visual masterpiece — it's about usability: the site must be actually used, easy to learn, memorable, effective, efficient, desirable, and delightful.

Attributes of Usability (from class notes)

Attribute	Question it answers
Useful	Does it do something people need done?
Learnable	Can people figure out how to use it?
Memorable	Do they have to relearn it each time they use it?
Effective	Does it get the job done?
Efficient	Does it do the job with a reasonable amount of time and effort?
Desirable	Do people want it?
Delightful	Is using it enjoyable, even pleasurable?

Usability = a person of average (or even below-average) ability and experience can figure out how to use a thing to accomplish something, without it being more trouble than it's worth.

Krug's First Law of Usability: 'Don't Make Me Think'

- Pages should be self-evident and self-explanatory — a user shouldn't have to spend mental effort figuring out how to use the site.
- On the internet, the competition is always one click away — if you frustrate users, they will simply go elsewhere (e.g., an airline site vs. Boston/NY airport rules).

How People Actually Use the Web

- We don't read pages — we scan them.
- We are usually on a mission (looking for something specific), not casually browsing.
- We know we don't need to read everything, and we're good at this kind of scanning/satisficing.
- What we see on a page depends on what's in our mind, and it's usually just a fraction of what's actually there.
- We don't read instructions because: (1) it's not important to us — how something works doesn't matter as long as we can use it; (2) once we find something that works, we stick with it rather than searching for a better way ('satisficing').

Six Core Web-Design Principles (from class notes)

41. **Billboard Design 101 —** design for scanning, not reading. Take advantage of visual conventions users already know; create a clear visual hierarchy — the more important something is, the more visually prominent it should be.
42. **Reduce clicks to frustration-free —** it's fine to have several clicks as long as each click is painless and users feel confident they're on the right track.
43. **Omit needless words —** the art of NOT writing for the web: cut 'happy talk' (fluffy intro text) and unnecessary instructions — both must go.
44. **Street signs and breadcrumbs —** design for navigation; users should always know where they are on the site and how to get back.
45. **Clear visual hierarchy —** group related items, nest logically, and show what's clickable.
46. **Consistency —** keep look, terminology, and navigation consistent across pages so learned behaviour transfers.

User-Centered Design & Website Optimization

- Design decisions are based on real user research (surveys, interviews, usability testing), not just internal opinion.
- Iterative process: research → wireframe → prototype → usability test → refine.
- Optimization includes A/B testing layouts, simplifying forms, and reducing friction in key user flows.

Design Principles and Website Copy

- Visual hierarchy, whitespace, consistent typography and colour system
- Mobile-first / responsive layout
- Website copy should be scannable: short paragraphs, bullet points, bolded key terms, clear CTAs
- Write for the reader's goal, not for the brand's ego — focus on benefits, not just features

UX vs UI — key distinction (from notes)

Aspect	UX (User Experience)	UI (User Interface)
Based on	User behaviour, psychology, goals	Visual aesthetics & design guidelines
User involvement	Conducting surveys, interviews, identifying pain points & needs	Designing interfaces that reflect user expectations & look appealing; not directly involved with users
Research	Understand user personas, define use cases, create user journeys	Not directly involved
Design activity	Sketch wireframes, create flowcharts, structure navigation	Design high-fidelity interfaces, style guides, icons, buttons
Testing	Usability testing, A/B testing	Test visual clarity, responsiveness, accessibility, look & feel
Focus	Experience and flow	Look and feel
Goal	Solve the user's problem	Create an engaging interface
Tools	Wireframes, personas, user journey maps	Layout tools, graphic design software
Output	Structure, logic, satisfaction	Visual mock-ups, design system
Designer role	Psychologist / strategist	Artist / stylist

Website Metrics & Developing Insight

- Bounce rate, average session duration, pages per session
- Conversion rate on key CTAs (sign-up, purchase, download)
- Page load speed and mobile usability score
- Heatmaps/scroll maps to see where users actually look and click

Steps to Website Optimization (from class notes)

47. **Set clear goals** — define KPIs such as conversion rate, bounce rate, avg. session duration.
48. **Conduct a website audit** — Google Analytics, page load speed, mobile friendliness, broken links, on-page SEO.
49. **Improve website speed & performance** — compress images, use faster hosting services.
50. **Optimize for mobile devices** — responsive design; test across multiple devices & browsers.
51. **Enhance UX and UI** — simple navigation, reliability.
52. **SEO** — keywords, URL structure.
53. **Optimize content.**
54. **Improve conversion elements** — CTAs, forms, trust signals.
55. **Test & iterate** — A/B testing.
56. **Monitor & maintenance** — ongoing tracking after launch.

Publishing a Basic Website

- Choose a domain name and hosting provider
- Select a platform/CMS (WordPress, Wix, Shopify) or code from scratch
- Build core pages: home, about, product/service, contact
- Set up analytics (Google Analytics) and search console before/at launch

- Test across browsers/devices, then go live

4.2 Mobile Marketing

Mobile Advertising vs Mobile Marketing

Mobile Advertising	Mobile Marketing
A subset/tactic — paid ads shown on mobile devices (in-app ads, mobile banner/search ads)	A broader strategy covering all marketing activities aimed at reaching users on mobile devices
Focused on driving clicks/impressions through paid placements	Includes SMS/MMS, push notifications, mobile apps, mobile-optimized websites, location-based marketing, QR codes, in addition to paid ads
Short-term, campaign-based	Ongoing relationship-building with the mobile user

Utilizing Mobile Marketing for Sales Promotions & Online Applications

- SMS/push notification campaigns for flash sales, discounts, and cart-abandonment reminders
- Location-based marketing (geofencing) to target users near a physical store
- In-app promotions and loyalty programs via branded mobile apps
- QR codes linking offline touchpoints (packaging, print ads) to online offers
- Mobile wallets/coupons for in-store redemption
- Ensuring all promotional content and checkout flows are mobile-optimized, since mobile now drives the majority of web traffic and purchase research

Unit IV — Likely SEE Questions (choose one of Q7/Q8)

57. Explain the different attributes of usability and Krug's 'Don't Make Me Think' principle.
58. Explain how people actually use/read web pages, and what this means for web design.
59. Discuss the key principles of good web design with suitable examples (billboard design, omit needless words, navigation, etc.).
60. Differentiate between UX and UI design with a comparative table.
61. Explain the steps involved in website optimization.
62. What is user-centered design? How does it influence website optimization and copy?
63. Differentiate between mobile advertising and mobile marketing, and explain how mobile marketing is used for sales promotions.

UNIT V — Conversion Optimization & Digital Analytics

5.1 Conversion Optimization

Conversion Rate Optimization (CRO) is the systematic process of increasing the percentage of website visitors who complete a desired action (purchase, sign-up, download) — Conversion Rate = (Number of conversions ÷ Total visitors) × 100.

What is AIDAS and its role?

AIDAS is a classic model of the stages a customer moves through before taking action — used to structure landing pages, ads, and sales copy so each section does its job in moving the visitor to the next stage.

Stage	What it means	How it's applied on a page
Attention	Capture the visitor's attention	Strong headline, hero image/video, bold visual hierarchy
Interest	Build interest by highlighting relevant benefits	Sub-headlines, feature highlights, storytelling
Desire	Create an emotional want for the product/service	Social proof, testimonials, benefit-led copy, urgency/scarcity
Action	Prompt the visitor to act	Clear, prominent call-to-action button/form
Satisfaction	Ensure post-purchase/action satisfaction	Confirmation pages, follow-up emails, good UX post-conversion — drives repeat business & referrals

Role of AIDAS: it gives marketers a structured checklist to diagnose WHY a page isn't converting — e.g., if attention is high (traffic is fine) but action is low, the issue is likely with the desire or CTA stage, not with awareness/traffic.

Website Optimization for Conversion

- Reduce friction — fewer form fields, guest checkout, autofill
- Build trust — reviews, security badges, clear return/refund policy
- Use urgency/scarcity ethically — limited-time offers, low-stock indicators
- Optimize page load speed — every extra second of load time reduces conversions
- Mobile-first design, since a large share of traffic and purchases happen on mobile

What Visitors Want to See on the Website

- Clear value proposition — what's in it for them, immediately visible above the fold
- Easy navigation to find products/information quickly
- Transparent pricing and policies
- Social proof — reviews, ratings, case studies, testimonials
- Clear, unambiguous next step (a single primary CTA per page)

How to Optimize a Key Element & Increase the Effect of a Landing Page

64. **Identify the single primary goal of the landing page (one CTA).**
65. **Match the headline/message to the ad or link that brought the visitor there (message match).**
66. **Use above-the-fold real estate for the value proposition and CTA.**
67. **Remove distractions — no unnecessary navigation links or competing CTAs.**
68. **A/B test one element at a time — headline, CTA colour/copy, hero image, form length.**
69. **Use analytics/heatmaps to see where visitors drop off, then fix that specific step.**

5.2 Digital Analytics

Evolution of Digital Analytics

- Early stage — simple web log/hit counters just counting page views/visits.

- Web analytics stage — tools like Google Analytics introduced sessions, bounce rate, funnels, and goal tracking.
- Multi-channel/omnichannel analytics — tracking users across web, mobile app, social, email, and offline touchpoints.
- Today — a shift toward AI-assisted, predictive and real-time analytics, and 'search everywhere' style tracking, because customer decisions now form across many platforms (search engines, marketplaces, social apps, AI assistants) rather than a single linear funnel.

End-to-End Customer Experience

- Digital analytics today aims to track the FULL customer journey — from first touchpoint (ad/search/social) through consideration, purchase, and post-purchase/loyalty — not just isolated website metrics.
- Requires connecting data across channels (attribution modelling) to understand which touchpoints truly influence conversion.

The Analyst's Influence on Business

- A good analyst doesn't just report numbers — they interpret data to recommend action (what to change, test, or invest in).
- They help set the right KPIs aligned to business goals, not just vanity metrics.
- They validate that analytics setup and interpretation are both correct before decisions are made on top of them (linking back to the 'human factor' idea from Unit III).

The Analyst's Role as a Change Agent

- Champions a data-driven culture within the organization, encouraging decisions based on evidence rather than opinion (HiPPO — 'highest paid person's opinion' — bias).
- Bridges the gap between raw data and business strategy by translating insights into actionable recommendations.
- Advocates for continuous testing and experimentation (A/B/multivariate testing) as an ongoing discipline, not a one-time project.
- Helps break down data silos between marketing, product, and sales teams so insights flow across the organization.

Unit V — Likely SEE Questions (choose one of Q9/Q10)

70. Explain the AIDAS model and its role in website/landing-page optimization.
71. What do visitors typically want to see on a website? How does this affect conversion optimization?
72. Explain how you would optimize a key landing page element to increase conversions.
73. Trace the evolution of digital analytics from basic web tracking to today's end-to-end customer experience analytics.
74. What is meant by 'end-to-end customer experience' in digital analytics?
75. Explain the analyst's influence on business decisions and their role as a change agent.
76. Discuss Conversion Rate Optimization (CRO) and the key techniques used to reduce visitor drop-off.

Quick-Revision Glossary (for Part A objective questions)

Term	One-line definition
SEO	Improving organic search visibility through content, technical, and authority optimization
SEM	Paid + organic search marketing combined
CTR	Click-through rate — % of viewers who click
CPC / CPM / CPA	Cost per click / per thousand impressions / per acquisition
Bounce rate	% of single-page visits with no further interaction
Persona	Semi-fictional profile of an ideal customer
AIDAS	Attention, Interest, Desire, Action, Satisfaction — customer decision model
CRO	Conversion Rate Optimization
UTM parameters	Tags added to URLs to track campaign source/medium in analytics
Funnel conversion	% of users completing each step from entry to final purchase
Share of voice	Brand's share of total online conversation vs. competitors
RICE framework	Reach, Impact, Confidence, Ease — prioritization model
On-page vs off-page SEO	Optimizations made on the site itself vs. external signals like backlinks
UX vs UI	User experience (how it works/feels) vs. user interface (how it looks)
Krug's Law of Usability	'Don't make me think' — pages should be self-evident
Geofencing	Location-based mobile marketing targeting users within a defined radius
Attribution modelling	Assigning credit for a conversion across multiple touchpoints

End of notes. Good luck for the SEE!